

ANUTTARA

Invocations of the Heart

A BOOK OF KASHMIR ŚAIVA PRAYER

न त्यागी न परिग्रही भज सुखं सर्वं यथावस्थितः

Neither renouncer nor possessor — enjoy
happiness, all of it, staying exactly as you are.

ABHINAVAGUPTA, ANUTTARĀṢṬIKĀ 1

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I

MAṄGALA

Invocation

Traditional praṇāma

Invocation to Gaṇeśa

शुक्लाम्बरधरं विष्णुं शशिवर्णं चतुर्भुजम् ।
प्रसन्नवदनं ध्यायेत् सर्वविघ्नोपशान्त्यये ॥

śuklāmbaradharaṁ viṣṇuṁ śaśivarṇaṁ caturbhujam |
prasannavadanaṁ dhyāyet sarvavighnopaśāntyaye ||

Clothed in white, all-pervading, moon-hued, four-armed, with a serene face — meditate on him for the stilling of every obstacle.

Invocation to Gaṇeśa

Traditional praṇāma

Gaṇeśa is invoked before the way is walked. White is sattva, the moon is reflective clarity, the four arms are the inner faculties brought to rest.

The book opens the way every Hindu ritual opens: with Gaṇeśa, the remover of obstacles.

The verse is a meditation instruction as much as a prayer — meditate on him — and the description is a map of the calm mind: white (sattva), moon-hued (reflective), four-armed (the inner faculties gathered), serene-faced (uncontracted).

In the Trika reading the obstacle is not only external: it is the contraction of awareness that makes the path seem far away. Say it at the threshold of any work, then pause for one breath before beginning.

Traditional text.

Traditional

Remover of Obstacles

वक्रतुण्ड महाकाय सूर्यकोटिसमप्रभ । निर्विघ्नं कुरु मे देव सर्वकार्येषु सर्वदा ॥

vakratuṇḍa mahākāya sūryakoṭisamaprabha |
nirvighnaṁ kuru me deva sarvakāryeṣu sarvadā ||
O curved-trunked one, great of body, radiant as a million suns — make me free of obstacles, O God, in every undertaking, always.

Remover of Obstacles

Traditional

The curved trunk is the bent course of grace: nothing goes straight, and yet nothing is lost. Ask for the obstacle to be removed, not avoided.

Where the first verse describes, this one asks. The address is intimate and a little comic: a great, curved-trunked body radiant like a million suns. The trunk bends — grace does not travel in straight lines.

The request is precise: not make me successful, but make me free of obstacles in every undertaking. Trika would add that the deepest obstacle is the sense of being a separate doer.

Say it when you meet the first resistance of the day; ask for the way to open, not for the world to flatten.

Traditional text.

Traditional dhyāna śloka

The Single Tusked

अगजानन पद्मार्कं गजाननं अहर्णिशम् ।
अनेकदन्तं भक्तानां एकदन्तं उपास्महे ॥

agajānana padmārkaṁ gajānanaṁ aharṇiśam |
anekadantaṁ bhaktānāṁ ekadantaṁ upāsmahe ||

The face born of the mountain, sun to the lotus — the elephant-faced one, day and night; many-tusked, and single-tusked for the sake of devotees, him we worship.

The Single Tusked

Traditional dhyāna śloka

ekadanta, the one tusk, is the single point of attention. Many forms for the world, one point for the devotee.

A dhyāna verse: it gives the mind a form to rest on. Born of the mountain is Pārvatī's son; sun to the lotus is the face that opens the heart. The pivot is ekadanta, the single tusk — many forms for the world, one point for the devotee.

The verse quietly teaches what the whole book assumes: multiplicity is not the enemy of attention; it is what attention is made of. Use it as a one-minute gaze practice. Recite it, then let the single point remain.

Traditional text.

Traditional

Invocation to the Guru

गुरुर् ब्रह्मा गुरुर् विष्णुः गुरुर् देवो महेश्वरः ।
गुरुः साक्षात् परं ब्रह्म तस्मै श्री गुरवे नमः ॥

gurur brahmā gurur viṣṇuḥ gurur devo maheśvaraḥ |
guruḥ sākṣāt paraṁ brahma tasmai śrī gurave namaḥ ||
The guru is Brahmā, the guru is Viṣṇu, the guru is the god Maheśvara; the guru is the supreme Brahman made visible — to that holy guru, namas.

Invocation to the Guru

Traditional

Trika reads the guru not as a person but as the point where consciousness turns to recognise itself. The three gods are the three powers — will, knowledge, action — and the guru is their source.

The guru verse is not flattery of a person. It maps the three powers — Brahmā (creation), Viṣṇu (preservation), Maheśvara (dissolution) — onto the one who shows you your own nature.

In Trika the guru is the moment consciousness recognises itself through another; the supreme Brahman made visible is not a body but that recognition.

Recite it before study or practice, bowing not to a personality but to the transmission that is still happening.

Traditional text.

Traditional Sarasvatī vandana

Invocation to Sarasvatī

या कुन्देन्दुतुषारहारधवला या शुभ्रवस्त्रावृता । या
वीणावरदण्डमण्डितकरा या श्वेतपद्मासना । या
ब्रह्माच्युतशङ्करप्रभृतिभिर् देवैः सदा पूजिता । सा मां पातु
सरस्वती भगवती निःशेषजाडयापहा ॥

yā kundendutuṣārahāradhavalā yā śubhravastrāvṛtā |
yā vīṇāvaradaṇḍamaṇḍitakarā yā śvetapadmāsanā | yā
brahmācyutaśaṅkaraprabhṛtibhir devaiḥ sadā pūjitā |
sā māṁ pātu sarasvatī bhagavatī niḥśeṣajāḍyāpahā ||

She who is white as jasmine, the moon, snow and a string of pearls; wrapped in bright cloth; her hands adorned with the vīṇā and the boon-giving staff; seated on a white lotus; ever worshipped by Brahmā, Acyuta, Śaṅkara and the gods — may that goddess Sarasvatī protect me, who takes away all dullness.

Invocation to Sarasvatī

Traditional Sarasvatī vandana

Sarasvatī is vāgdevī, the power of speech; in Trika the same power is the world-making throb of consciousness. Ask not for information but for the removal of jāḍya, the inertness that cannot see.

Sarasvatī is vāgdevī, speech itself. The verse piles up whites — jasmine, moon, snow, pearls — until the mind is washed clean, then gives her the vīṇā (sound) and the boon-staff (grace). The final request is exact: remove jāḍya, the inertness that cannot see.

In Trika, speech is not a tool added to consciousness; it is the throb by which consciousness manifests. Recite before writing, speaking, or teaching, and ask for the removal of dullness rather than for more words.

Traditional text.

Ṛgveda 3.62.10

Gāyatrī

ओं भूर् भुवः स्वः । तत् सवितुर् वरेण्यं । भर्गो देवस्य धीमहि । धियो यो नः प्रचोदयात् ॥

oṁ bhūr bhuvaḥ svaḥ | tat savitur vareṇyaṁ | bhargo devasya dhīmahi | dhiyo yo naḥ pracodayāt ||
Oṁ — earth, mid-air, heaven. We meditate on that desirable radiance of the divine Sun; may it impel our thoughts.

Gāyatrī

Ṛgveda 3.62.10

The oldest mantra of the light. Trika reads the three worlds as the three states — waking, dream, deep sleep — and the Sun as the witness-consciousness that lights all three.

The Gāyatrī is the oldest light-prayer in the tradition. Three worlds are named, then the desirable radiance of the sun, then the request: impel our thoughts.

Trika reads the three worlds as the three states of experience, and the sun as the witness that lights all three without being any of them. It is not a petition for things but for the movement of intelligence itself.

Recite it at dawn, or before any act that needs clarity, and let the mind be the thing that is lit.

Traditional text.

Īśa Upaniṣad, invocation

The Fullness

ओं पूर्णम् अदः पूर्णम् इदं पूर्णात् पूर्णम् उदच्यते ।
पूर्णस्य पूर्णम् आदाय पूर्णम् एवावशिष्यते ॥

oṁ pūrṇam adaḥ pūrṇam idaṁ pūrṇāt pūrṇam udacyate | pūrṇasya pūrṇam ādāya pūrṇam evāvaśiṣyate ||

Oṁ. That is full, this is full. From the full the full proceeds. Taking the full from the full, the full alone remains.

The Fullness

Īśa Upaniṣad, invocation

The purest statement of pūrṇāhantā, the full I. Manifestation does not diminish the source; the world is the fullness in another key.

The Īśa invocation is a meditation on fullness. That is full, this is full — the source and the world are not two quantities, one of which drains the other. From the full the full proceeds; take the full from the full and the full remains.

This is pūrṇāhantā, the full I, the heart of Trika's non-duality. Use it as a frame: say it before practice, and let the arithmetic of loss break. Nothing is diminished by appearing.

Traditional text.

II

NĀMA

The Name

Pañcākṣara mantra

Oṁ Namaḥ Śivāya

ओं नमः शिवाय

oṁ namaḥ śivāya

Oṁ — I bow to Śiva.

Oṁ Namaḥ Śivāya

Pañcākṣara mantra

The five syllables are the five acts: naḥ creation, maḥ preservation, śi dissolution, vā concealment, ya grace. Oṁ, a+u+ṃ, is the triad of will, knowledge and action. To repeat it is to let the whole cycle turn inside you.

The pañcākṣara is the most portable Trika prayer. The five syllables are the five acts — creation, preservation, dissolution, concealment, grace — and Oṁ is the triad of will, knowledge and action.

So the mantra is not a petition to a distant god; it is the whole cycle of manifestation folded into sound, turning inside the one who repeats it. Say it aloud or mentally: let naḥ open, maḥ hold, śi release, vā hide, ya return. The Name does the work.

Translation: practice file

Recognition mantra

Śivo'ham

शिवोऽहम्

śivo'ham

I am Śiva.

Śivo'ham

Recognition mantra

The recognition, pratyabhijñā, in two words. Not I will become Śiva — the I that says it is already the light.

Two words, and the whole recognition. Śivo'ham is not a claim to be a deity; it is the confession that the I you just used is not the ego.

In Trika, pratyabhijñā is re-cognition: you have always been this, and the mantra removes the forgetting. Say it slowly and notice what says it.

If it feels like a lie, that is the contraction speaking — repeat it as a question rather than an assertion, and let the question stay open.

Translation: pūrṇāhantā, par-p02–p03

The breath mantra

So'ham

सोऽहम्

so'ham

That am I.

So'ham

The breath mantra

The natural mantra of the breath: sa on the in-breath, haṃ on the out — haṃsa. You do not recite it; you notice it has been reciting you.

So'ham is the mantra you cannot stop saying. The breath already makes it: sa on the in-breath, haṃ on the out — haṃsa, the swan. The practice is not to add a mantra but to notice the one already running.

Trika calls this ajapa, the unmuttered. Sit for a few minutes and let the breath say it; do not force the syllables. The recognition is that awareness is breathing you, and has been all along.

Translation: so'haṃ entry

Bṛhadāraṇyaka Upaniṣad 1.4.10

Ahaṁ Brahmāsmi

अहं ब्रह्मास्मि

ahaṁ brahmāsmi

I am Brahman.

Ahaṁ Brahmāsmi

Bṛhadāraṇyaka Upaniṣad 1.4.10

Read in the Trika key, the I is not the ego but the full, self-luminous Śiva. The mahāvākya is a recognition, not a claim.

A mahāvākya of the Upaniṣads, read by Lakshmanjoo in the Trika key: the I is not the small self but the full, self-luminous Śiva. Brahman and Śiva are two names for the same recognition.

The sentence is not a proposition to believe but a pointer to what is already the case. Say it once, then sit in the silence it leaves. The silence is the commentary; the sentence is only the door.

Traditional text.

Ṛgveda 7.59.12

Mṛtyuñjaya

ओं त्र्यम्बकं यजामहे सुगन्धिं पुष्टिवर्धनम् ।
उर्वारुकम् इव बन्धनान् मृत्योर् मुक्षीय मामृतात् ॥

oṁ tryambakaṁ yajāmahe sugandhiṁ puṣṭivardhanam | urvārukam iva bandhanān mṛtyor mukṣīya māmṛtāt ||
Oṁ. We worship the three-eyed one, fragrant, who increases fullness. As a cucumber is freed from its vine, may we be freed from death — and not from immortality.

Mṛtyuñjaya

Ṛgveda 7.59.12

Trika reads mṛtyu as the death-contraction: the ego that thinks it can die. The vine is the bond of limited identity; the freedom asked is not escape from life but release into the deathless.

The Mṛtyuñjaya is a Vedic prayer for release from death — and, in Trika, from the death-contraction of the ego. The image is exact: a cucumber is not torn from the vine but gently freed as it ripens.

The last phrase is the surprise: not from immortality — do not release me from the deathless. The prayer asks to be let go into what cannot die. Recite it for the sick, the dying, and one's own fear.

Traditional text.

Traditional Śiva dhyāna

The Camphor-White Lord

कर्पूरगौरं करुणावतारं संसारसारं भुजगेन्द्रहारम् ।
सदावसन्तं हृदयारविन्दे भवं भवानीसहितं नमामि ॥

karpūragauraṁ karuṇāvatāraṁ saṁsārasāraṁ
bhujagendrahāram | sadāvasantaṁ hṛdayāravinde
bhavaṁ bhavānīsahitaṁ namāmi ‖

Camphor-white, the very descent of compassion, the essence of the world, wearing the king of serpents as a garland — ever dwelling in the lotus of the heart, I bow to Bhava with Bhavānī beside him.

The Camphor-White Lord

Traditional Śiva dhyāna

The white of camphor is the brightness of pure consciousness; the serpent garland is the coiled power worn openly. Bhava with Bhavānī is not two: the one heart.

A dhyāna verse for Śiva: camphor-white (pure consciousness), compassion descended (grace taking form), the essence of the world (not its enemy), the serpent worn openly (the coiled power).

The final line places him in the heart, with Bhavānī — Śiva and Śakti together, the one heart. Use it as an image to rest in: recite, then feel the white brightness in the chest. It is a prayer of sheer beauty, and beauty is a means of recognition.

Traditional text.

III

STUTI

Invocations of Śiva

Abhinavagupta, Bhairavastava 1

Refuge in Bhairava

व्याप्तचराचरभावविशेषं चिन्मयम् एकम् अनन्तम् अनादिम् । भैरवनाथम् अनाथशरण्यं त्वन्मयचित्ततया हृदि वन्दे ॥

vyāptacarācarabhāvaviśeṣaṁ cinmayam ekam anantam anādim | bhairavanātham anāthaśaraṇyaṁ tvanmayacittatayā hṛdi vande ||

Pervading every particular state of the moving and unmoving, made of consciousness, one, endless, beginningless — Bhairava the Lord, refuge of the refugeless: with a mind become you, in the heart I bow.

Refuge in Bhairava

Abhinavagupta, Bhairavastava 1

Abhinavagupta opens: the Lord is not a being among beings but the consciousness that pervades every state. The bow is made by the mind becoming him, not by the body bending.

Abhinavagupta opens his hymn by refusing to look for Bhairava anywhere in particular. The Lord pervades every particular state — moving and unmoving — and is consciousness-made, one, endless, beginningless.

Then the human turn: refuge of the refugeless. The bow is made with a mind become you — not a body bending but attention consenting. Begin here when the world feels scattered: the many states are the one consciousness in different keys.

Translation: bh-p01

Abhinavagupta, Bhairavastava 5

I Never Fear

इत्थम् उपोढभवन्मयसंविद्दीधितिदारितभूरितमिस्रः ।
मृत्युयमान्तककर्मपिशाचैर् नाथ नमोऽस्तु न जातु
बिभेमि ॥

ittham
upoḍhabhavanmayasaṁviddīdhitidāritabhūritamisraḥ
| mṛtyuyamāntakakarmapiśācair nātha namo'stu na
jātu bibhemi ||
Thus, with the great darkness torn open by the rays of the consciousness become you — Lord, namas; I never fear, not from death, from Yama, from the ender, from the ghosts of karma.

I Never Fear

Abhinavagupta, Bhairavastava 5

Fearlessness is not courage; it is what remains when the darkness has been burned by awareness. The devotee still names death and karma, but salutes them instead of fleeing.

This is the great fearlessness verse. Awareness has already torn the darkness; what remains is not courage but salutation.

Abhinavagupta names the ministers of death — Mṛtyu, Yama, the ender, the ghosts of karma — and bows to them, because they too are Śiva's play. The line I never fear is not bravado; it is the natural temperature of recognition.

Recite it at night, or when fear arrives. Do not argue with fear — salute it.

Translation: bh-p05

Abhinavagupta, Anuttarāṣṭikā 1

No Method

संक्रामो ऽत्र न भावना न च कथायुक्तिर् न चर्चा न च ध्यानं वा न च धारणा न च जपाभ्यासप्रयासो न च । तत् किं नाम सुनिश्चितं वद परं सत्यं च तच्छ्रूयतां न त्यागी न परिग्रही भज सुखं सर्वं यथावस्थितः ॥

saṁkrāmo 'tra na bhāvanā na ca kathāyuktir na carcā na ca dhyānaṁ vā na ca dhāraṇā na ca japābhyāsaprayāso na ca | tat kiṁ nāma suniścitaṁ vada paraṁ satyaṁ ca tacchrūyatāṁ na tyāgī na parigrahī bhaja sukhaṁ sarvaṁ yathāvasthitaḥ ||

There is no crossing over here — no contemplation, no connecting speech, no discussion, no visualization, no steadying, no effort of japa. So what is decided? Speak the supreme truth; hear it: not a renouncer, not a possessor — enjoy happiness, all of it, staying exactly as you are.

No Method

Abhinavagupta, Anuttarāṣṭikā 1

The anupāya, the no-means. When every method is denied, what is left is recognition: you are already what you seek. Staying as you are is not passivity; it is the end of the search.

The Anuttarāṣṭikā begins by taking away every method. No contemplation, no speech, no discussion, no visualization, no steadying, no japa. Then the question: what is decided?

The answer is the anupāya, the no-means: not renouncer, not possessor — enjoy happiness, staying as you are. This is not licence; it is the end of the search. Say it when you notice yourself trying to become something.

The trying is the only distance.

Translation: anu-p01

Abhinavagupta, Anuttarāṣṭikā 8

Lordhood

यत् सत्यं यद् असत्यम् अल्पबहुलं नित्यं न नित्यं च यत् यन्
मायामलिनं यद् आत्मविमलं चिद्दर्पणे राजते । तत् सर्वं
स्वविमर्शसंविदुदयाद् रूपप्रकाशात्मकं ज्ञात्वा
स्वानुभवाधिरूढमहिमा विश्वेश्वरत्वं भज ॥

yat satyaṁ yad asatyam alpabahulaṁ nityaṁ na nityaṁ ca yat yan māyāmalinaṁ yad ātmavimalaṁ ciddarpaṇe rājate | tat sarvaṁ svavimarśasaṁvidudayād rūpaprakāśātmakaṁ jñātvā svānubhavādhirūḍhamahimā viśveśvaratvaṁ bhaja ||

Whatever is real and whatever is unreal, little or much, eternal or not; whatever shines stained by māyā or pure as the self in the mirror of consciousness — know it all to be the light of form arising from one's own self-awareness; then, with a glory mounted on your own experience, enjoy the Lordhood of the universe.

Lordhood

Abhinavagupta, Anuttarāṣṭikā 8

The last verse of the Anuttarāṣṭikā: the world is neither to be rejected nor grasped, but seen as the shining of one's own awareness. Lordhood is not a title but the taste of that seeing.

The last verse of the Anuttarāṣṭikā gathers the whole world into the mirror of consciousness. Real and unreal, eternal and momentary, stained by māyā or pure — all of it is the light of form arising from one's own awareness.

The instruction is not to judge the world but to see its shining, and then to enjoy Lordhood. Lordhood is not power over things; it is the taste of seeing them as yourself. A verse for the end of practice.

Translation: anu-p08

Abhinavagupta, Pañcaślokī 1

The Offering of Pride

यत् सत्यं तु मया कृतं मम विभो कृत्यं तु नातः परं यन् मन्मानम् ऐशपादकमले भक्त्या मयैवार्पितम् । सर्वस्वम् अत एवम् एतद् इतरन् नासीव जानाम्य् अतस् त्यक्त्वा क्षिप्रम् अनाथनाथ करुणासिन्धो प्रसन्नो भव ॥

yat satyaṁ tu mayā kṛtaṁ mama vibho kṛtyaṁ tu nātaḥ paraṁ yan manmānam aiśapādakamale bhaktyā mayaivārpitam | sarvasvam ata evam etad itaran nāsīva jānāmy atas tyaktvā kṣipram anāthanātha karuṇāsindho prasanno bhava ||

Whatever I have truly done, O Lord — my duty goes no further than this: my pride has been offered by me, with devotion, at the lotus feet of the Lord. This is my all; apart from this I know nothing else. Therefore, casting everything else aside, quickly — O protector of the refugeless, O ocean of compassion — be pleased.

The Offering of Pride

Abhinavagupta, Pañcaślokī 1

The one offering that costs everything: not wealth, but pride. Abhinavagupta asks for nothing except that the offering be accepted.

The Pañcaślokī is a hymn of pure surrender, and this is its first offering. Abhinavagupta does not offer wealth or ritual: he offers his pride. This is my all, he says; apart from this he knows nothing.

The request is not for a boon but for acceptance — be pleased. In Trika the last possession is the sense of being the one who offers; when that is offered too, only compassion remains. Recite it when you have nothing left to bring.

Translation: pan-p01

Abhinavagupta, Pañcaślokī 2

Victory at the Door

महेश त्वद्द्वारि स्फुरतु रुचिरा वाग् अतितरां मम एषा निर्दोषं जय जय महेशेति सततम् । शिवा सैषा वाणी भवतु शिवदा मह्यम् अनिशं महेशनाथं मां शरणद सनाथं कुरु विभो ॥

maheśa tvaddvāri sphuratu rucirā vāg atitarāṁ mama eṣā nirdoṣaṁ jaya jaya maheśeti satatam | śivā saiṣā vāṇī bhavatu śivadā mahyam aniśaṁ maheśanāthaṁ māṁ śaraṇada sanāthaṁ kuru vibho ||

O Maheśa, may this lovely speech of mine flash forth at your door, faultlessly, again and again: Victory, victory to Maheśa! May this auspicious speech be giver of bliss to me, unceasingly. O Lord, O giver of refuge, make me — whose protector is Maheśanātha — to have a protector.

Victory at the Door

Abhinavagupta, Pañcaślokī 2

The prayer of one who has nothing to offer but speech. Make me to have a protector is the whole of śaraṇāgati: not to become strong, but to be held.

The second verse is the prayer of one who has only speech. At the Lord's door the devotee asks that the words victory, victory to Maheśa flash forth faultlessly and unceasingly. Then the real request: make me to have a protector.

Śaraṇāgati is not becoming strong; it is being held. Say it at the threshold of the day, or whenever self-reliance has become a burden. The words themselves are the offering.

Translation: pan-p02

Somananda, Śivadṛṣṭi 7.103

Śiva Bows to Śiva

अस्मद्रूप समाविष्टः स्वात्मनात्म निवारणे ।
शिवः करोतु निजया नमः शक्त्या ततात्मने ॥

asmadrūpa samāviṣṭaḥ svātmanātma nivāraṇe | śivaḥ karotu nijayā namaḥ śaktyā tatātmane ||
Śiva, having entered the form that is myself, bows — by his own power — to Śiva, for the removal of the obstacle that is himself.

Śiva Bows to Śiva

Somananda, Śivadṛṣṭi 7.103

The most Trika of prayers: the one who bows, the one bowed to, and the obstacle removed are all Śiva. Nothing is outside the recognition, not even the thing that blocks it.

This single verse is the whole Trika in miniature. Śiva enters the form that is myself, and then Śiva bows to Śiva; the obstacle being removed is also Śiva; the power doing the removing is Śiva's own.

Nothing is outside the recognition — not even the thing that blocks it. The verse is traditionally linked with Lakshmanjoo's mealtime practice: the bow, the food, and the hunger are one. Recite it when you feel divided; the division is the Lord's play.

Translation: Śivadṛṣṭi 7.103 (provisional)

Kṣemarāja, Parāprāveśikā, opening

The Heart of the Supreme

विश्वात्मिकां तदुत्तिर्णां हृदयं परमेशितुः ।
परादिशक्तिरूपेण स्फुरन्तीं संविदं नुमः ॥

viśvātmikāṁ taduttirṇāṁ hṛdayaṁ parameśituḥ |
parādiśaktirūpeṇa sphurantīṁ saṁvidaṁ numaḥ ||

We bow to consciousness itself — the heart of the supreme Lord, whose very self is the world, and which yet transcends it, pulsing in the form of the supreme power.

The Heart of the Supreme

Kṣemarāja, Parāprāveśikā, opening

Kṣemarāja opens by bowing to consciousness: not to a god, but to the heart that is both the world and beyond it. This is the doorway into the Supreme.

Kṣemarāja opens the Parāprāveśikā, the Entering into the Supreme, by bowing to consciousness itself. Not to a god, but to the heart of the supreme Lord — which is both the world (whose very self is the world) and beyond it.

The supreme power is parā-śakti, the highest throb. The verse is a doorway: before any practice, turn to the one who is doing the turning. Say it as an opening invocation, then enter the book.

Translation: par-p01

Vasugupta, Spandakārikā 1.1

The Wheel of Powers

यस्योन्मेषनिमेषाभ्यां जगतः प्रलयोदयौ । तं शक्तिचक्रविभवप्रभवं शङ्करं स्तुमः ॥

yasyonmeṣanimeṣābhyāṁ jagataḥ pralayodayau | taṁ śakticakravibhavaprabhavaṁ śaṅkaraṁ stumaḥ ||

To him by whose opening and closing the world dissolves and arises — to Śaṅkara, source of the glory of the wheel of powers, we sing.

The Wheel of Powers

Vasugupta, Spandakārikā 1.1

The opening of the Spandakārikā. The opening and closing is the pulse, spanda, of consciousness: the world appears and dissolves in the blink of the one who sees.

The Spandakārikā opens with a hymn to the pulse. By the Lord's opening and closing — his blink — the world dissolves and arises. The wheel of powers is the circle of śaktis through which consciousness manifests.

To sing it is to join the pulse rather than resist it. Trika's whole practice is to recognise this spanda in one's own breath, thought and perception. Recite it when the world feels solid; let it become a blink.

Translation: Spandakārikā 1.1

Kṣemarāja, Spandasandoha 1

He Alone Wins

स जयति शिव एकः स्पन्दवान् स्वप्रतिष्ठः योऽन्तर्वक्त्रं रसयति

sa jayati śiva ekaḥ spandavān svapratiṣṭhaḥ yo'ntarvaktraṁ rasayati

He alone wins — Śiva, possessor of the pulse, self-established, who makes the inner face taste.

He Alone Wins

Kṣemarāja, Spandasandoha 1

A one-line victory song. The inner face is attention turned back on itself; to taste it is the whole of the practice.

Kṣemarāja's Spandasandoha is a condensation of the Spandakārikā, and it opens with a one-line victory song. He alone wins — Śiva, possessor of the pulse, self-established, who makes the inner face taste.

The inner face is attention turned back on itself; to taste it is the whole of the practice. This is a verse to say after meditation, when the ordinary world returns: the taste is still there.

Translation: v.1

IV

ŚAKTI

The Goddess

The Secret of the Heart

एतद् गुह्यं महागुह्यं कथयस्व मम प्रभो । हृदयस्था तु या शक्तिः कौलिनी कुलनायिका । ताम् मे कथय देवेश येन तृप्तिं व्रजाम्य् अहम् ॥

etad guhyaṁ mahāguhyaṁ kathayasva mama prabho | hṛdayasthā tu yā śaktiḥ kaulinī kulanāyikā | tām me kathaya deveśa yena tṛptiṁ vrajāmy aham ‖

Tell me, Lord, this secret — the great secret: the power that dwells in the heart, the Kaulinī, the leader of the clan. Tell me that, O Lord of gods, by which I may reach fulfilment.

The Secret of the Heart

Parātrīśikā 1

The Goddess asks for the secret of the heart, and the answer is the anuttara, the unsurpassed. The whole Parātrīśikā is this question and its answer.

The Parātrīśikā opens as a dialogue: the Goddess asks Bhairava for the great secret — the power that dwells in the heart, the Kaulinī, the leader of the clan. The answer, when it comes, is the anuttara, the unsurpassed.

The verse is therefore the question that makes the whole book possible: what is the power in the heart by which fulfilment is reached? Recite it as a question, not a demand; the asking is already the turning.

Translation: para-p01

Devī Māhātmya, traditional

The Power in All Beings

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु शक्तिरूपेण संस्थिता ।
नमस्तस्यै नमस्तस्यै नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥

yā devī sarvabhūteṣu śaktirūpeṇa saṁsthitā |
namastasyai namastasyai namastasyai namo namaḥ ||

The goddess who dwells in all beings in the form of power — to her, to her, to her, namas, namas.

The Power in All Beings

Devī Māhātmya, traditional

In Trika this power in all beings is Śakti: not a goddess beside Śiva but the very throb by which consciousness knows itself. The triple namas dissolves the threefold difference.

This is the refrain of the Devī Māhātmya, the great hymn to the Goddess: she who dwells in all beings as power. In Trika that power is Śakti — not a goddess beside Śiva but the very throb by which consciousness knows itself.

The triple namas is precise: it dissolves the threefold difference of knower, knowing and known. Say it when the world feels inert; the power is already there, in every being, including this one.

Traditional text.

V

KRIYĀ

The Daily Practice

Bhagavad Gītā 4.24

The Meal Offering

ब्रह्मार्पणं ब्रह्म हविर् ब्रह्माग्नौ ब्रह्मणा हुतम् ।
ब्रह्मैव तेन गन्तव्यं ब्रह्मकर्मसमाधिना ॥

brahmārpaṇaṁ brahma havir brahmāgnau brahmaṇā hutam | brahmaiva tena gantavyaṁ brahmakarmasamādhinā ||

The offering is Brahman, the oblation is Brahman, poured by Brahman into the fire that is Brahman; Brahman alone is reached by one absorbed in the action that is Brahman.

The Meal Offering

Bhagavad Gītā 4.24

Lakshmanjoo's mealtime yajña. Read Brahman as Śiva throughout: what you eat, the eating, the eater, and the fire of digestion are one. Say it with water in the palm before food.

This is the meal verse Lakshmanjoo taught: water in the palm, then the offering. Read Brahman as Śiva throughout — the offering, the oblation, the fire, the one who offers and the goal are one.

The verse turns eating into yajña: food is not taken from the world but offered within it. Say it before food, and let the four Brahmans collapse into one taste. It is the most ordinary and the most complete prayer in the book.

Traditional text.

Bhagavad Gītā 15.14

The Fire Within

अहं वैश्वानरो भूत्वा प्राणिनां देहम् आश्रितः ।
प्राणापानसमायुक्तः पचाम्य् अन्नं चतुर्विधम् ॥

ahaṁ vaiśvānaro bhūtvā prāṇināṁ deham āśritaḥ |
prāṇāpānasamāyuktaḥ pacāmy annaṁ caturvidham ||

Becoming the fire of digestion, I dwell in the bodies of living beings; joined with the in-breath and the out-breath, I digest the four kinds of food.

The Fire Within

Bhagavad Gītā 15.14

Śiva as vaiśvānara, the inner fire: kriyā-śakti at work in the body. The meal is not merely eaten; it is cooked by consciousness.

The Lord speaks as the digestive fire. This is kriyā-śakti at work in the body: consciousness not only witnesses the meal but cooks it.

The verse pairs naturally with the meal offering — one verse for the offering, this one for the digestion. Trika sees the body as the Lord's temple and its processes as his play.

Say it after food, or during any ordinary bodily act, and let the ordinary become the location of the sacred.

Traditional text.

Bhagavad Gītā 9.26

A Leaf, a Flower

पत्रं पुष्पं फलं तोयं यो मे भक्त्या प्रयच्छति ।
तद् अहं भक्त्युपहृतम् अश्नामि प्रयतात्मनः ॥

patraṁ puṣpaṁ phalaṁ toyaṁ yo me bhaktyā prayacchati | tad ahaṁ bhaktyupahṛtam aśnāmi prayatātmanaḥ ‖

Whoever offers me a leaf, a flower, a fruit or water with devotion — that offering of the pure-hearted, given with love, I eat.

A Leaf, a Flower

Bhagavad Gītā 9.26

Bhakti is the only currency. The smallest thing, given wholly, is the whole. In Trika the gift and the giver are already Śiva.

Kṛṣṇa's promise is almost shockingly small: a leaf, a flower, a fruit, water. The value is not in the gift but in the bhakti — the wholeness of the giving. That offering of the pure-hearted I eat.

In Trika the gift and the giver are already Śiva, so the offering is never refused. Use it when you have little to give: the smallness is not the point; the devotion is. A verse for everyday generosity.

Traditional text.

Bhagavad Gītā 18.66

The Final Refuge

सर्वधर्मान् परित्यज्य माम् एकं शरणं व्रज । अहं त्वां सर्वपापेभ्यो मोक्षयिष्यामि मा शुचः ॥

sarvadharmān parityajya mām ekaṁ śaraṇaṁ vraja | ahaṁ tvāṁ sarvapāpebhyo mokṣayiṣyāmi mā śucaḥ ||
Abandoning all dharmas, take refuge in me alone. I will free you from all sins — do not grieve.

The Final Refuge

Bhagavad Gītā 18.66

The anupāya again: when every rule is set down, only turning remains. Do not grieve is the promise that the turning is enough.

The final instruction of the Gītā: abandon all dharmas and take refuge in the one. This is the anupāya in Kṛṣṇa's voice — when every rule has been set down, only turning remains. I will free you from all sins; do not grieve.

The grief is the last obstacle, and the promise addresses it directly. Recite it when the path feels heavy with obligations; the refuge is not another obligation but the end of them.

Traditional text.

All This Is Pervaded

ईशावास्यम् इदं सर्वं यत् किं च जगत्यां जगत् ।
तेन त्यक्तेन भुञ्जीथा मा गृधः कस्यस्विद् धनम् ॥

īśāvāsyam idaṁ sarvaṁ yat kiṁ ca jagatyāṁ jagat |
tena tyaktena bhuñjīthā mā gṛdhaḥ kasyasvid dhanam ‖

All this — whatever moves in the moving world — is pervaded by the Lord. Enjoy by renunciation; do not covet anyone's wealth.

All This Is Pervaded

Īśa Upaniṣad 1

The world is not to be fled but seen as pervaded. Enjoy by renunciation is the Trika paradox: possess nothing, and the whole is yours.

The Īśa opens with a vision, not a command: all this, whatever moves, is pervaded by the Lord. Then the paradox: enjoy by renunciation.

Not possess nothing and be miserable, but possess nothing and enjoy everything, because the whole is already the Lord's. Trika reads tyāga not as giving up the world but as giving up the illusion of ownership.

Say it when grasping begins; let the world be the Lord's, and it becomes yours.

Traditional text.

Utpaladeva, Śivastotrāvalī 17.19

In Every Action

अनुभूयासम् ईशान प्रतिकर्म क्षणात् क्षणम् ।
भवत्पूजामृतापानमदास्वादमहामुदम् ॥

anubhūyāsam īśāna pratikarma kṣaṇāt kṣaṇam |
bhavatpūjāmṛtāpānamadāsvādamahāmudam ||
O Lord, may I experience, moment by moment, in every action, the great joy of drinking the nectar of your worship.

In Every Action

Utpaladeva, Śivastotrāvalī 17.19

Utpaladeva's prayer for the ordinary: not more ritual, but the taste of worship inside every action. Moment by moment is the practice.

Utpaladeva's prayer is for the ordinary: not more ritual, but the taste of worship inside every action.

Moment by moment is the practice — not a single ecstasy but the repeated return of attention to the nectar of the Lord's worship. The verse asks for the great joy of drinking that nectar in each act.

Use it as a walking prayer: at each transition, say it, and let the next action become worship.

Translation: 17.19

Utpaladeva, Śivastotrāvalī 17.26

This Body for Worship

अन्तरुल्लसदच्छाच्छभक्तिपीयूषपोषितम् ।
भवत्पूजोपयोगाय शरीरम् इदम् अस्तु मे ॥

antarullasadacchācchabhaktipīyūṣapoṣitam |
bhavatpūjopayogāya śarīram idam astu me ||
May this body of mine — nourished by the clear, bright nectar of devotion rising within — be fit only for your worship.

This Body for Worship

Utpaladeva, Śivastotrāvalī 17.26

The body is not renounced; it is turned into an instrument of worship. Nourished by devotion, it becomes the offering itself.

The body is not renounced here; it is consecrated. Nourished by the clear nectar of devotion rising in the heart, the body becomes fit for worship — and then it is the offering itself.

This is the Trika answer to the body-denying traditions: the body is the Lord's instrument, and devotion makes it luminous. Say it in the morning, before the body begins its work; let the day be worship.

Translation: 17.26

Utpaladeva, Śivastotrāvalī 9.14

At Your Cool Feet

अशेषविषयाशून्यश्रीसमाश्लेषसुस्थितः ।
शयीयम् इव शीताङ्घ्रिकुशेशययुगे कदा ॥

aśeṣaviṣayāśūnyaśrīsamāśleṣasusthitaḥ | śayīyam iva śītāṅghrikuśeśayayuge kadā ||

When will I lie down — free of every object, settled in the embrace of undiminished glory — at your two cool lotus feet?

At Your Cool Feet

Utpaladeva, Śivastotrāvalī 9.14

The sleep prayer. Free of every object is not blankness but the rest that remains when the mind stops reaching. The cool feet are the peace of Śiva.

The sleep prayer. Utpaladeva asks when he will lie down free of every object, settled in undiminished glory, at the two cool lotus feet.

Free of every object is not blankness; it is the rest that remains when the mind stops reaching. The cool feet are the peace of Śiva, the coolness after the fever of wanting.

Say it in bed, and let the body be the offering it already is.

Translation: 9.14

Utpaladeva, Śivastotrāvalī 16.8

I Don't Mind

विषमस्थोऽपि स्वस्थोऽपि रुदन्न् अपि हसन्न् अपि । गम्भीरोऽपि विचित्तोऽपि भवेयं भक्तितः प्रभो ॥

viṣamastho'pi svastho'pi rudann api hasann api | gambhīro'pi vicitto'pi bhaveyaṁ bhaktitaḥ prabho ||
In crisis or at ease, weeping or laughing, grave or unhinged — by devotion, Lord, let me be so.

I Don't Mind

Utpaladeva, Śivastotrāvalī 16.8

The api-chain refuses resolution: sorrow and joy, sanity and its loss, are all allowed. Devotion is not the absence of any of them; it is what holds them.

The api-chain refuses to resolve. Crisis or ease, weeping or laughing, grave or unhinged — all of it is allowed. Devotion is not the absence of any of these; it is what holds them.

Utpaladeva's prayer is not to become calm but to be devotion through whatever arises. Say it when the day is chaotic; do not wait for composure. The very mess is the place where devotion can be.

Translation: 16.8

VI

NAMASKĀRA

Salutations

Utpaladeva, Śivastotrāvalī 2.1

Fire, Moon, Sun

अग्नीषोमरविब्रह्मविष्णुस्थावरजङ्गम । स्वरूप बहुरूपाय नमः संविन्मयाय ते ॥

agnīṣomaravibrahmaviṣṇusthāvarajaṅgama | svarūpa bahurūpāya namaḥ saṁvinmayāya te ‖

Fire, moon, sun, Brahmā, Viṣṇu, the moving and the unmoving — to you whose own form is many-formed, to you made of consciousness, namas.

Fire, Moon, Sun

Utpaladeva, Śivastotrāvalī 2.1

A salutation to the many-formed one. The many forms are not a veil; they are how consciousness shows itself. The name of the many is still made of consciousness.

A salutation to the many-formed one. Fire, moon, sun, Brahmā, Viṣṇu, the moving and unmoving — all are his forms, and all are made of consciousness.

The verse does not choose between the many and the one; it names the many and then names their substance. Trika's non-duality is not the erasure of difference but its transfiguration.

Say it facing the day's multiplicity; let each thing be a form of the one.

Translation: 2.1

Utpaladeva, Śivastotrāvalī 2.8

Saṁsāra and Beyond

संसारैकनिमित्ताय संसारैकविरोधिने । नमः
संसाररूपाय निःसंसाराय शम्भवे ॥

saṁsāraikanimittāya saṁsāraikavirodhine | namaḥ
saṁsārarūpāya niḥsaṁsārāya śambhave ||
To the one who is the sole cause of saṁsāra and the sole opponent of saṁsāra; to Śambhu, who is the form of saṁsāra and is beyond saṁsāra, namas.

Saṁsāra and Beyond

Utpaladeva, Śivastotrāvalī 2.8

A paradox of the recognition: the world's bondage and its release are the same Lord. There is no enemy outside.

A paradox of the recognition: the one who is the sole cause of saṁsāra is also its sole opponent. Bondage and release are the same Lord, seen from two sides.

There is no enemy outside to defeat; the world's very form is Śambhu, and it is also beyond the world. Say it when you are tempted to split experience into spiritual and worldly; the split is the only saṁsāra.

Translation: 2.8

Utpaladeva, Śivastotrāvalī 2.19

All Conduct, No Conduct

दक्षिणाचारसाराय वामाचाराभिलाषिणे ।
सर्वाचाराय शर्वाय निराचाराय ते नमः ॥

dakṣiṇācārasārāya vāmācārābhilāṣiṇe | sarvācārāya śarvāya nirācārāya te namaḥ ||
To the essence of the right-hand way, to the one who longs for the left-hand way, to the all-way, to Śarva, to the wayless — to you, namas.

All Conduct, No Conduct

Utpaladeva, Śivastotrāvalī 2.19

Every path is his, and no path is. The verse exhausts all conduct — and then the wayless remains.

Every path is his, and no path is. The verse names the right-hand way, the left-hand way, the all-way — and then the wayless.

Utpaladeva is not saying all paths are equally true in their rules; he is saying the Lord is not confined by any of them. The final wayless is the anupāya.

Say it when you meet someone on a different path, or when your own path feels like a cage.

Translation: 2.19

Utpaladeva, Śivastotrāvalī 2.25

Mass of Nectar

परमामृतकोशाय परमामृतराशये ।
सर्वपारम्यपारम्यप्राप्याय भवते नमः ॥

paramāmṛtakośāya paramāmṛtarāśaye |
sarvapāramyapāramyaprāpyāya bhavate namaḥ ||
To you, the treasure of supreme nectar, the mass of supreme nectar, the goal of every goal and of the goal beyond — to you, namas.

Mass of Nectar

Utpaladeva, Śivastotrāvalī 2.25

The Name as nectar: not a word about sweetness, but the sweetness itself. The goal of every goal is the recognition that there is nothing beyond.

The Name as nectar. The verse piles up supreme nectar — treasure, mass, goal of every goal and of the goal beyond. It is not a word about sweetness; it is the sweetness itself.

The goal beyond the goal is the recognition that there is nothing beyond: the seeking ends in what was always here. Say it slowly, as a taste rather than a petition.

Translation: 2.25

Utpaladeva, Śivastotrāvalī 20.9

The Five Acts

सदा सृष्टिविनोदाय सदा स्थितिसुखासिने सदा त्रिभुवनाहारतृप्ताय स्वामिने नमः ॥

sadā sṛṣṭivinodāya sadā sthitisukhāsine sadā tribhuvanāhāratṛptāya svāmine namaḥ ‖

To the Master who ever delights in creation, ever sits at ease in preservation, ever is satisfied with the three worlds as food — namas.

The Five Acts

Utpaladeva, Śivastotrāvalī 20.9

One bow contains the five acts: creation, preservation, and the devouring that is dissolution — with grace hidden in delight and ease.

One bow contains the five acts: creation (delight), preservation (ease), dissolution (the three worlds as food), and the grace hidden in both.

The verse is a whole cosmology in a salutation — and it ends with Master, not Lord: the one who is near.

Say it at the end of the day, when creation, maintenance and loss have all happened; bow to the one who was doing all three.

Translation: 20.9

VII

ŚĀNTI

Peace

Traditional offering verse

Whatever I Do

कायेन वाचा मनसेन्द्रियैर् वा बुद्ध्यात्मना वा प्रकृतेः स्वभावात् । करोमि यद् यत् सकलं परस्मै नारायणायेति समर्पयामि ॥

kāyena vācā manasendriyair vā buddhyātmanā vā prakṛteḥ svabhāvāt | karomi yad yat sakalaṁ parasmai nārāyaṇāyeti samarpayāmi ‖

Whatever I do with body, speech, mind or senses, with intellect or self, by the nature of my constitution — all of it I offer to the Supreme, to Nārāyaṇa.

Whatever I Do

Traditional offering verse

The closing offering. Every act, conscious or automatic, is handed over. In the non-dual reading Nārāyaṇa is Śiva, the one who dwells in all.

The closing offering. Whatever I do — with body, speech, mind, senses, intellect, or by the sheer nature of my constitution — all of it is offered to the Supreme.

The list is deliberately exhaustive: nothing is left outside. In the non-dual reading, Nārāyaṇa is Śiva, the one who dwells in all.

Say it at the end of practice, or at the end of the day; let the whole ledger be handed over.

Traditional text.

Traditional śānti

May All Be Happy

ओं सर्वे भवन्तु सुखिनः सर्वे सन्तु निरामयाः ।
सर्वे भद्राणि पश्यन्तु मा कश्चिद् दुःखभाग् भवेत् ॥

oṁ sarve bhavantu sukhinaḥ sarve santu nirāmayāḥ |
sarve bhadrāṇi paśyantu mā kaścid duḥkhabhāg bhavet ||
Oṁ. May all be happy; may all be free of illness; may all see what is good; may no one be touched by sorrow.

May All Be Happy

Traditional śānti

The universal śānti. In the recognition, all is not a crowd outside; it is the one consciousness in many forms.

The universal śānti. Four wishes: happiness, health, the vision of what is good, and freedom from sorrow. In the recognition, all is not a crowd outside; it is the one consciousness in many forms.

So the prayer is not a polite addition to the personal practice — it is the natural radiation of recognition. Say it at the close, and let the circle widen until it includes what you would rather exclude.

Traditional text.

Traditional

Oṁ Śāntiḥ

ओं शान्तिः शान्तिः शान्तिः

oṁ śāntiḥ śāntiḥ śāntiḥ

Oṁ — peace, peace, peace.

Oṁ Śāntiḥ

Traditional

Three śāntis for the three disturbances: body, speech and mind — or the three worlds, the three powers, the three states.

Three śāntis: for body, speech and mind — or the three worlds, the three powers, the three states. Repetition is not redundancy; it is the sealing of each layer.

The book ends where it began, in the simplest possible utterance. Say it three times, slowly, and let the silence after the third be the last page.

Traditional text.

ॐ शान्तिः शान्तिः शान्तिः

peace, peace, peace

ANUTTARA

SOURCES

NAMAH-SHIVAYA.JSON

sources/namah-shivaya.json
practice file

PARAPRAVESIKA.MD

sources/parapravesika.md
pūrṇāhantā, par-p02–p03, par-p01

MANTRAS.JSON

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17.19, 17.26, 9.14, 16.8, 2.1, 2.8, 2.19, 2.25, 20.9